



Imagine an animal that looks like it's from another planet; that's the star-nosed mole for you! This creature has 22 little tentacles at the end of its nose that look like a star, hence the name, star-nosed mole. Covered in thick, black fur, their bodies are cylindrical and they have large, paddle-like hands for digging. But wait till you hear about their super cool living habits and what's on their menu!



Remember the big hands I told you about? They help the mole live its life underground in wet, marshy areas in North America. These moles are super good at swimming, and can even find food underwater! Speaking of food, these creatures love to munch on small invertebrates, worms, and even small fish. You won't believe how quickly they can eat, it's almost like watching a magic trick!

Speaking of magic tricks, let's delve into the life cycle of these fascinating creatures. After a gestation period of about 45 days, the female star-nosed mole gives birth to a litter of 2 to 7 baby moles. These baby moles grow up fast and are ready to leave the nest within a month. Despite their somewhat scary look, star-nosed moles are harmless to humans and play an important role in the ecosystem.



Star-nosed moles are quite different from other moles, and not just because of their funky noses!. Unlike other moles, they are super quick, and their star-nose helps them to find and eat food faster than the blink of an eye. Their noses are also super sensitive, and they use them to 'see' their surroundings. So next time you think of moles, remember the star-nosed mole, a fascinating creature that's as interesting as it is unusual!



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) What do star-nosed moles use their hands for?
A. Climbing trees B. Hitting enemies C. Digging D. Swimming
- 2) Is the star-nosed mole dangerous to humans?
A. It can be dangerous if provoked. B. Only the star-nose part is harmful to touch.
C. Yes, it is dangerous to humans. D. No, the star-nosed mole is harmless to humans.
- 3) What does a star-nosed mole eat?
A. Plants, leaves and fruits B. Seeds and grains like a mouse
C. Large animals like gazelles and zebras D. Small invertebrates, worms, and small fish
- 4) How long does it take for the babies to leave the nest?
A. After 1 year. B. After 6 months.
C. They never leave the nest. D. Within a month.
- 5) How many babies does a female star-nosed mole usually have?
A. 2 to 7 B. 1 C. more than 15 D. 8 to 12
- 6) Can star-nosed moles swim?
A. No, they cannot swim B. Yes, they are good at swimming
C. They can not swim, they immediately sink D. They can only float
- 7) How long is the gestation period of a star-nosed mole?
A. 9 months, like a human baby B. 1 year, like a baby elephant
C. About 45 days D. 2 weeks, like a baby mouse
- 8) Are star-nosed moles slow or fast?
A. Neither fast nor slow B. It depends on the mole
C. Slow D. Fast
- 9) What color is the star-nosed mole's fur?
A. gray B. brown C. black D. white
- 10) Where does the star-nosed mole live?
A. on top of mountains B. in tree nests
C. in marshy areas D. in caves

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 11) "I live mostly in wet and marshy areas in North America.!"
- 12) "Our babies stay with us for about 2 years before venturing on their own."
- 13) "Baby moles are born fully grown and independent."
- 14) "Swimming just isn't my thing, I usually stay on land."
- 15) "I have 22 little tentacles at the end of my nose that look like a star."
- 16) "My hands are big and paddle-like, just perfect for digging underground."



Star Nosed Mole

Name: _____

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. _____ | 26. _____ | 51. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 27. _____ | 52. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 28. _____ | 53. _____ |
| 4. _____ | 29. _____ | 54. _____ |
| 5. _____ | 30. _____ | |
| 6. _____ | 31. _____ | |
| 7. _____ | 32. _____ | |
| 8. _____ | 33. _____ | |
| 9. _____ | 34. _____ | |
| 10. _____ | 35. _____ | |
| 11. _____ | 36. _____ | |
| 12. _____ | 37. _____ | |
| 13. _____ | 38. _____ | |
| 14. _____ | 39. _____ | |
| 15. _____ | 40. _____ | |
| 16. _____ | 41. _____ | |
| 17. _____ | 42. _____ | |
| 18. _____ | 43. _____ | |
| 19. _____ | 44. _____ | |
| 20. _____ | 45. _____ | |
| 21. _____ | 46. _____ | |
| 22. _____ | 47. _____ | |
| 23. _____ | 48. _____ | |
| 24. _____ | 49. _____ | |
| 25. _____ | 50. _____ | |



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Star Nosed Mole

Name: _____

1.	C	26.	fact	51.	declarative
2.	D	27.	opinion	52.	declarative
3.	D	28.	fact	53.	interrogative
4.	D	29.	opinion	54.	interrogative
5.	A	30.	fact		
6.	B	31.	fact		
7.	C	32.	opinion		
8.	D	33.	opinion		
9.	C	34.	true		
10.	C	35.	false		
11.	Would	36.	true		
12.	Not	37.	false		
13.	Not	38.	true		
14.	Not	39.	false		
15.	Would	40.	false		
16.	Would	41.	false		
17.	Not	42.	true		
18.	Not	43.	true		
19.	Not	44.	B		
20.	Would	45.	A		
21.	Not	46.	D		
22.	Would	47.	A		
23.	Not	48.	C		
24.	fact	49.	declarative		
25.	opinion	50.	interrogative		